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Opportunities in APAC IPO Markets

Evaluating the viability of public listings for private-capital-backed companies

PitchBook is a Morningstar company providing the most comprehensive, most accurate, and hard-to-find data for professionals doing business in the private markets.

Key takeaways

- Amid macroeconomic uncertainty and rising geopolitical tension, APAC's IPO markets have entered a more selective phase. While deal volume has remained steady post-2021, listing value has fallen sharply, reflecting tighter investor scrutiny and a higher bar for public market readiness.
- India stands out as the most resilient market, with VC- and PE-backed IPOs more than doubling from 2022 to 2024. Strong domestic liquidity, stable macro conditions, and active pipelines in consumer, fintech, and cleantech continue to support public exits.
- Meanwhile, Japan has maintained steady IPO volume for profitable mid-sized companies. Investors remain focused on asset-light B2B sectors such as healthcare and industrial technology, with institutional support and governance reforms reinforcing pricing discipline. South Korea also remains active, particularly in healthcare and tech, but faces challenges around post-IPO performance and institutional confidence.
- China has seen a sharp decline in sponsor-backed IPOs, driven by weak sentiment and regulatory intervention. Listings continue in policy-aligned or consumption-driven sectors, but liquidity remains constrained by long lockups and foreign investment limits. Southeast Asia remains structurally limited, with few scalable, IPO-ready companies and thin capital markets. Public exits are rare and largely confined to mid-cap, cash-generative businesses in local consumer sectors.
- PitchBook's IPO Predictor highlights healthcare, IT, and consumer sectors as the most IPO-ready across APAC, with high-probability candidates concentrated in India, Korea, and Japan. Yet the realization of these pipelines will depend on company fundamentals, macro timing, and listing venue dynamics.

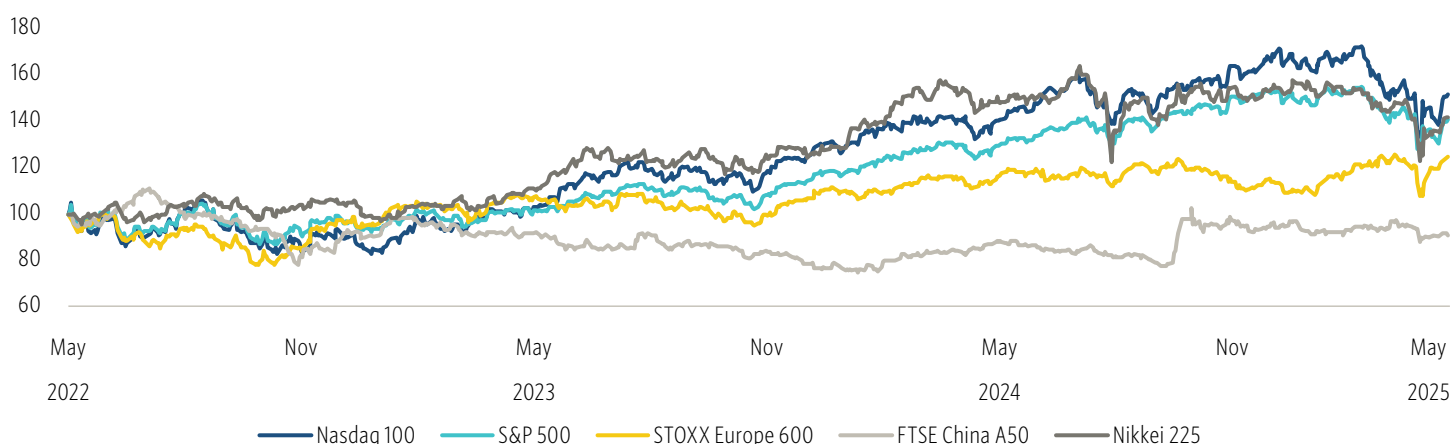
APAC IPO market struggling but still primed for performance

The uneven recovery of Asia-Pacific (APAC) IPO markets and the highly selective pipeline of likely listings highlight a deeper structural transition underway. Rather than a temporary lull, we are witnessing a more permanent shift in the ways in which companies can exit via public markets. This transition reflects not just cyclical headwinds but also fundamental changes in capital markets, investor behavior, and regulatory posture across the region.

Liquidity is becoming more concentrated, with only a few exchanges such as India's National Stock Exchange and Japan's Tokyo Stock Exchange demonstrating the depth and resilience to consistently support sponsor-backed IPOs. At the same time, regulatory tightening and political sensitivities, particularly in China, have constrained cross-border listings and blurred the boundaries between capital formation and industrial policy. In parallel, investor expectations have reset, prioritizing earnings visibility, governance quality, and capital efficiency over scale or market share. These shifts are gradually reshaping the viability of IPOs as a primary liquidity channel for private capital.

Nevertheless, the outlook for 2025 is not without opportunity. If realized, even a fraction of the current high-probability IPO pipeline—concentrated in sectors like healthcare, AI, and consumer platforms—could deliver meaningful DPI across the region. But access to that upside will depend less on market timing and more on deliberate preparation, policy awareness, and executional discipline. APAC's IPO window has not closed, but it has become narrower, more conditional, and structurally differentiated. The path forward belongs not to those waiting for sentiment to turn, but to those building for resilience.

Public market returns (rebased to 100 in 2022)



Source: Morningstar • Geography: APAC • As of May 29, 2025

Top five recent IPOs by exit size

Company	Close date	Total invested (\$M)	Exit value (\$M)	Post-money valuation (\$M)	Industry sector	Country
Swiggy	November 13, 2024	\$534.8	\$9,840.4	\$10,375.2	B2C	India
Bajaj Housing Finance	September 16, 2024	\$424.2	\$6,522.1	\$6,946.3	Financial services	India
Horizon Robotics	October 24, 2024	\$695.6	\$5,992.6	\$6,688.2	IT	China
Hexaware Technologies	February 19, 2025	N/A	\$4,954.8	\$4,954.8	IT	India
KIOXIA	December 18, 2024	\$206.0	\$4,943.9	\$5,149.9	IT	Japan

Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

Recent IPO trends in APAC

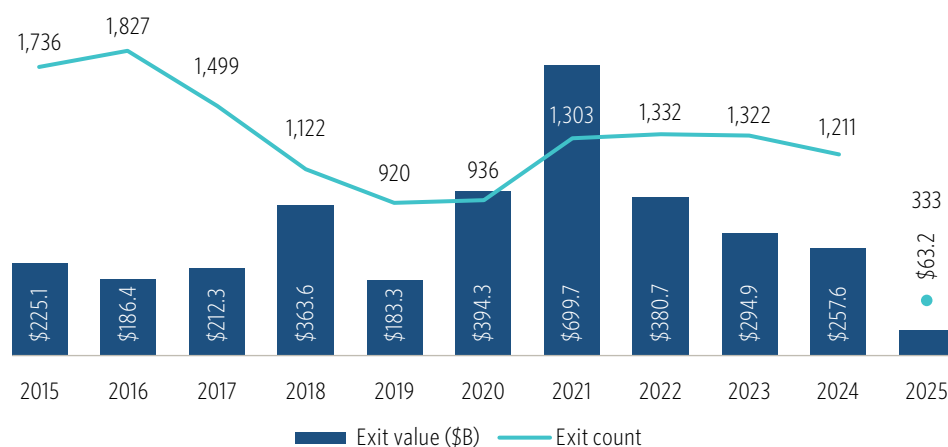
Over the past decade, IPOs have been a cornerstone of APAC's private capital exit landscape and have steadily grown as a proportion of total exits in the region. Between 2015 and 2019, the region saw a steady stream of listings at an average of about 1,400 IPOs each year, though PE- and VC-backed exits accounted for only around 16% of those listings. India contributed outsized exits during sectoral rallies, particularly in fintech, energy, and consumer platforms.

2020-2021 then saw expanded IPO activity due to the liquidity-driven boom in that period, with the IPO count reaching 1,303 in 2021 as technology names drove high valuations across multiple markets. Alongside that growth, PE- and VC-backed companies further expanded their activity levels, with such listings representing more than 37% of new listings during those years. Southeast Asia briefly joined the wave via landmark SPAC listings such as Grab and Bukalapak, raising expectations of a structural listing shift that ultimately proved short-lived as investor focus pivoted back to fundamentals.

The post-2021 period marked a sharp correction. While IPO count remained at an average of about 1,300 per year between 2022-2024, IPO value fell significantly from 2021's all-time high, reflecting a marked shift in investor sentiment and listing

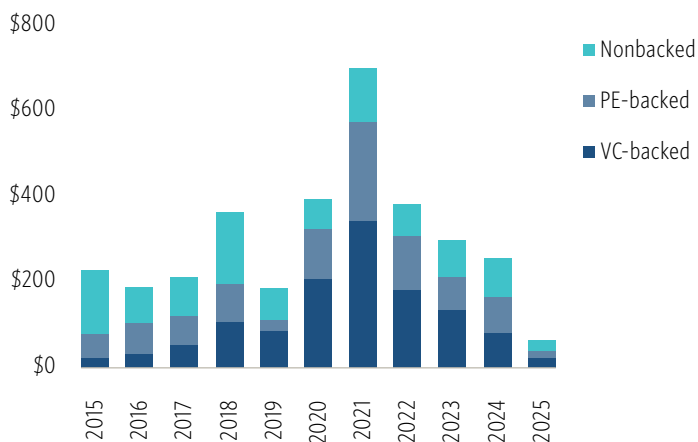
quality. The retreat in value was driven by multiple factors: rising global interest rates, which raised the cost of capital and compressed valuations; macroeconomic uncertainty, particularly around inflation and geopolitical risks; and a wider recalibration in the public market's appetite for risk, especially for high-growth, loss-making companies. Investor focus pivoted away from revenue growth toward profitability and business model durability, thereby narrowing the field of companies able to command premium valuations. As a result, although headline IPO activity appeared resilient, much of the volume came from smaller, lower-value listings concentrated in mature sectors and domestic markets, rather than the blockbuster tech or cross-border deals that had defined the 2021 boom.

IPO activity



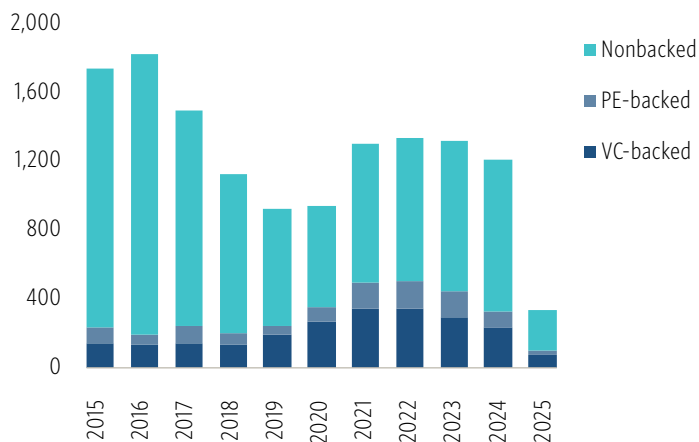
Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

IPO value (\$B) by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

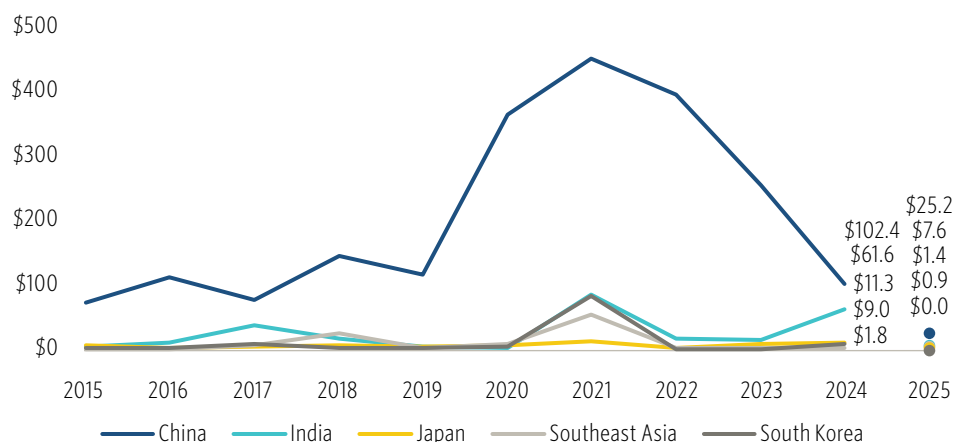
IPO count by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

Macroeconomic overlays continue to shape the IPO calculus. As of early 2025, capital outflows from emerging markets and currency volatility across APAC (especially in Indonesia, Malaysia, and South Korea) present new headwinds. Meanwhile, renewed US-China trade friction under the Trump administration adds another layer of policy risk, particularly for export-dependent sectors. IPO viability is no longer a function of sector or growth alone; it now depends heavily on a company's ability to meet profitability thresholds, local investor sentiment, and macro-political positioning.

Combined PE and VC IPO post-money valuation (\$B) by country

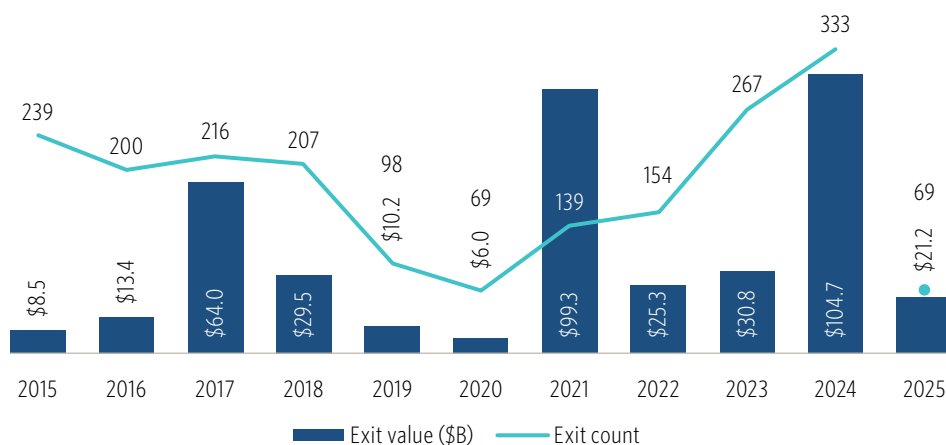


Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

India: An increasingly popular public exit channel

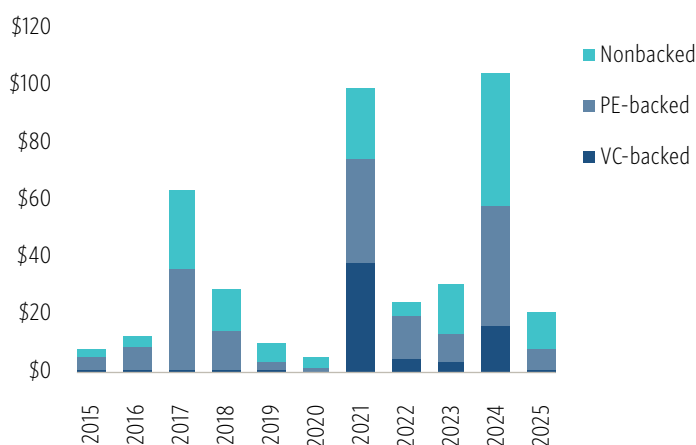
India has emerged as one of the most resilient IPO markets in APAC, benefiting from strong domestic liquidity, stable macroeconomic conditions, and a deepening equity culture. Within the region, India stands out as the only major market that recorded growth in VC- and PE-backed IPO deal count from 2022 to 2024, rising from 22 to 56 deals, while activity declined elsewhere. This relative resilience reflects India's unique position as one of the few regional ecosystems where IPOs continue to serve as a viable exit route for late-stage private capital.

India IPO activity



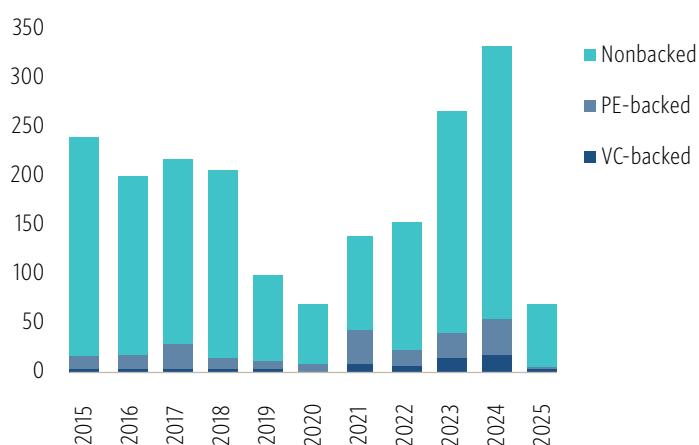
Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

India IPO value (\$B) by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

India IPO count by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

A key driver of this resilience is India's high retail participation and supportive monetary environment, which have allowed its equity markets to outperform global peers. The benchmark Sensex and Nifty 50 indexes both posted double-digit gains in 2024, buoyed by strong earnings growth in sectors such as banking, energy, and consumer services. Additionally, IPO valuations remained relatively stable, with median enterprise value (EV)/EBITDA multiples for new listings holding in the 15x-20x range.

Consumer and fintech IPOs continue to dominate the landscape, reflecting India's demographic scale and digitization momentum and the increasing monetization of daily life via formal financial infrastructure. Key drivers include rising discretionary income, widespread mobile adoption, and the success of platforms built around embedded financial services and e-commerce ecosystems. Notable exits in 2024 included Swiggy, which went public at a \$9.8 billion valuation and enabled full exits for major investors, highlighting that meaningful DPI is achievable through public listings in India. Bajaj Housing Finance, another marquee listing, debuted at a valuation of \$6.5 billion, reinforcing investor appetite for financial services with scalable, asset-light models.

Looking ahead, India's IPO pipeline remains the most active in the region. The country's continued strength will be supported by both macro and structural tailwinds: consistent GDP growth, infrastructure-led public investment, expanding domestic institutional capital pools, and a visible reallocation of global capital away from China. As geopolitical risk premiums shift and capital flows adjust, India is increasingly seen as a preferred destination for scalable, public-market-ready companies.

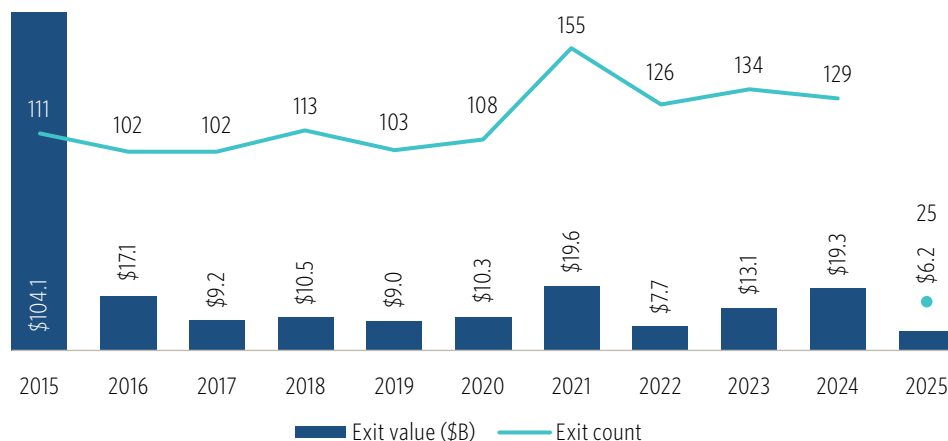
Japan: Predictable exits for profitable midsized companies

Despite global volatility and rising investor selectivity, Japan has maintained a steady cadence of IPOs, particularly for profitable midsized companies. IPO activity peaked in 2021, but deal counts from 2022 to 2024 exceeded pre-2021 levels, suggesting a normalization rather than a collapse. Notably, the average post-money valuation recovered sharply after the 2022 reset, with 2024 marking the highest median post-money valuation for VC- and PE-backed IPOs in over a decade, suggesting that public investors remain willing to price up listings that meet their profitability and quality benchmarks.

This is especially true in industrials, healthcare, and applied technology, where companies tend to be profitable, asset-light, and suited to Japan's conservative investor base. Two recent examples underscore this trend: Kioxia, an IT hardware company with a \$4.9 billion post-money valuation, and Rigaku, a healthcare instrumentation company with a \$1.9 billion post-money valuation. Both operate in high-skill B2B segments with stable revenue profiles and limited exposure to global tech volatility.

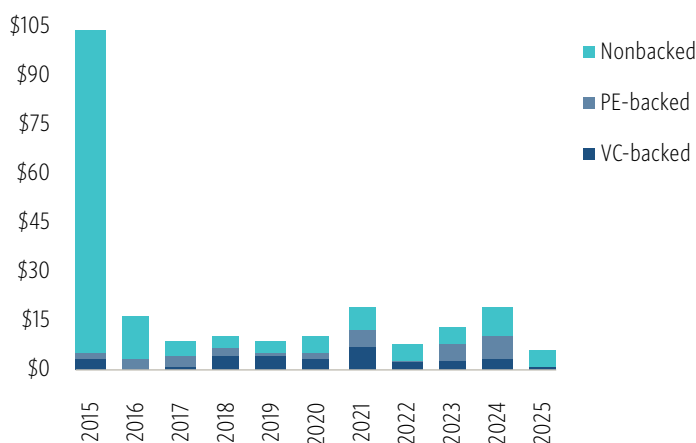
Japan's broader macro environment has further supported IPO feasibility. In 2024, the Nikkei 225 hit record highs, aided by corporate governance reform, a weak yen supporting exporters, and reallocation of global capital into Japan amid decoupling from China. Domestic institutional investors remain the key buyers of IPOs, and their focus on earnings quality and risk-adjusted returns has helped reinforce IPO pricing discipline and deal stability.

Japan IPO activity



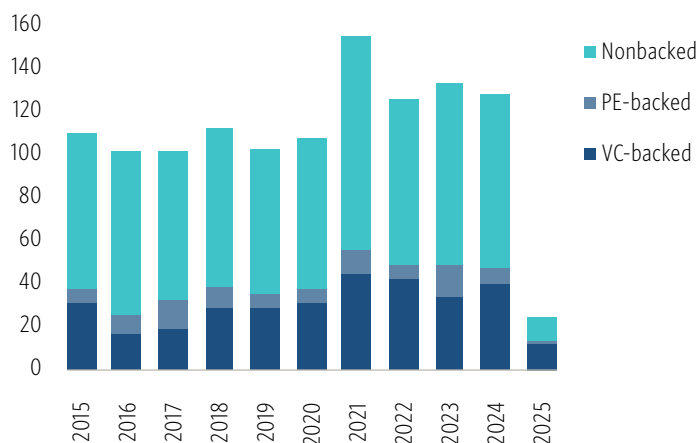
Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

Japan IPO value (\$B) by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

Japan IPO count by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

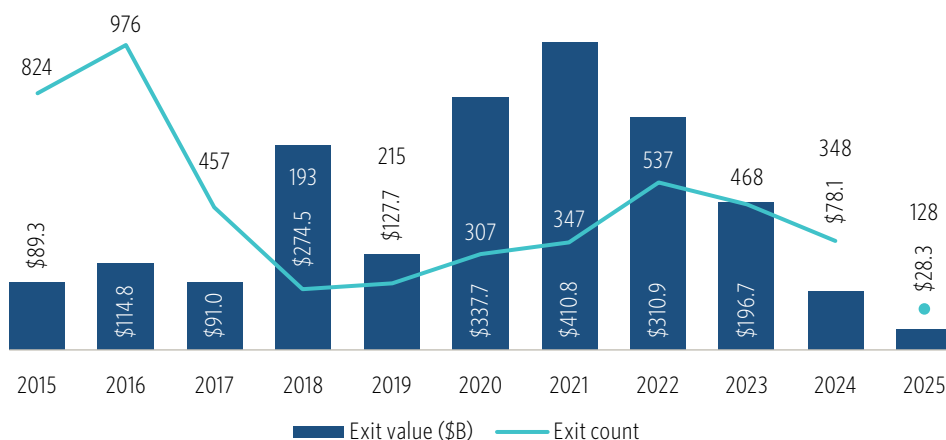
China: A constrained exit channel

For most private capital investors, China's IPO market has ceased to function as a broad-based exit mechanism. From 2023 to 2024, VC-backed and PE-backed IPO exits dropped 54% and 73%, respectively, extending a multiyear decline. Several factors drove this decline. The macro backdrop remains fragile, shaped by sluggish consumer demand, property sector stress, and weak private sector confidence. On top of that, IPO activity took another hit in March 2024, when regulators suspended the registration-based listing system across most exchanges. Aimed at curbing inflated valuations and speculative flows, the move gave the China Securities Regulatory Commission tighter control over approvals and led to a wave of delays for in-progress deals. Sponsor-backed companies, particularly in high-valuation sectors like tech and consumer, have been among the hardest hit.

Still, not all windows are closed. IPOs in China are still happening, but only under specific conditions. Recent listings that did move forward tended to fall into one of two camps:

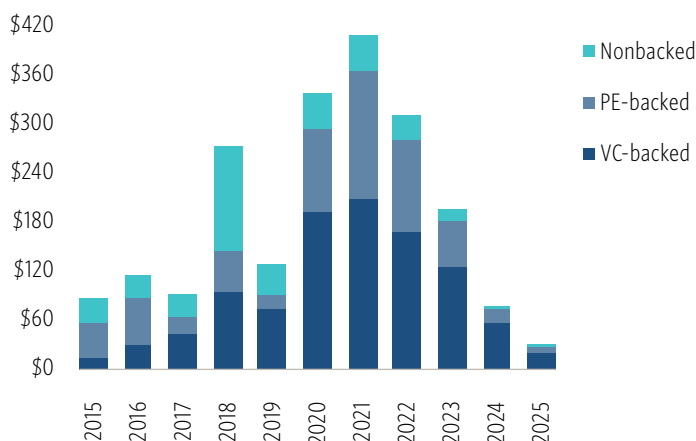
- Policy-aligned sectors, such as semiconductors, robotics, and biopharma, where state support and capital market reform agendas intersect. Examples include Horizon Robotics, with an exit size of \$6 billion in October 2024, as well as Beijing Tongcheng Bing Technology, with an exit size of \$3.3 billion in the same month.
- Domestic consumption-driven companies, particularly in politically neutral categories like food, beverage, and health & wellness. Recent IPOs, such as CR Beverage, highlight how well-positioned consumer brands with local loyalty can still go public despite the broader market downturn.

China IPO activity



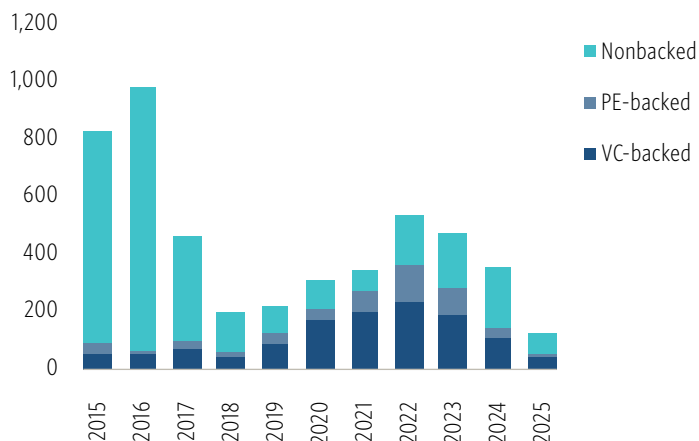
Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

China IPO value (\$B) by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

China IPO count by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

Top 10 recent IPOs in China

Company	Total invested (\$M)	Exit value (\$M)	Post-money valuation (\$M)	Industry sector
Horizon Robotics	\$695.6	\$5,992.6	\$6,688.2	IT
Chagee	\$411.2	\$4,728.2	\$5,139.4	B2C
WeRide	\$120.0	\$4,134.6	\$4,254.6	B2C
CR Beverage	\$648.8	\$3,730.3	\$4,379.1	B2C
Air China Cargo	\$417.4	\$3,377.2	\$3,794.6	B2B
Beijing Tongcheng Bing Technology	\$198.0	\$3,317.5	\$3,515.5	B2B
Cha Panda	\$330.2	\$2,972.2	\$3,302.4	B2C
Zenergy	\$129.3	\$2,539.8	\$2,669.1	B2B
YXT.COM Group Holding	\$25.0	\$1,932.3	\$1,957.3	Financial services
Black Sesame Technologies	\$132.7	\$1,908.4	\$2,041.0	IT

Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

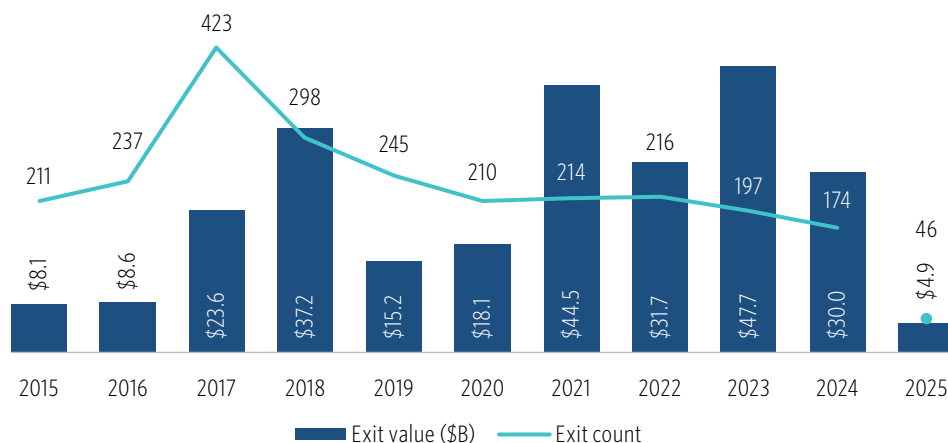
Southeast Asia: IPOs remain the exception, not the norm

Southeast Asia remains the weakest IPO environment among major APAC markets. After the 2021 SPAC boom, public exits for PE- and VC-backed companies collapsed. Only a handful of deals were recorded in 2024, and median post-money valuations remain below 2018-2021 levels.

The primary challenge facing the region is the inability to scale. Few startups in the region are generating the revenues, margins, or corporate governance standards that public investors now expect, particularly after the SPAC drawdown and the global tech repricing. While capital markets in Indonesia and Malaysia have shown signs of life, they have primarily supported local industrial or consumer-facing businesses, not growth-stage tech companies backed by private capital. The Singapore Exchange, once a candidate for regional tech listings, continues to face liquidity constraints and weak aftermarket performance. And despite strong investor interest, Vietnam remains largely inaccessible for foreign-backed IPOs and is still in the early stages of building out institutional-grade capital markets.

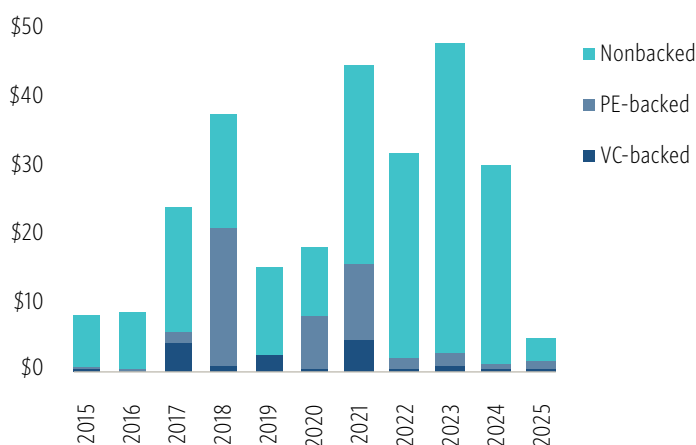
That said, the IPO window in Southeast Asia is not entirely closed; it is simply narrow. A select group of cash-generating, mid-cap companies with strong domestic market positions have successfully gone public, such as Yupi in Indonesia and The Thai Credit Retail Bank in Thailand. However, these deals are the exception rather than the norm, and they rarely reflect the high-growth, high-burn venture model that dominates early-stage investing in the region. In this environment, the IPO path exists largely in theory, not in practice, for most early- and growth-stage portfolios. Strategic M&A and secondary-led exits remain more realistic avenues for liquidity.

Southeast Asia IPO activity



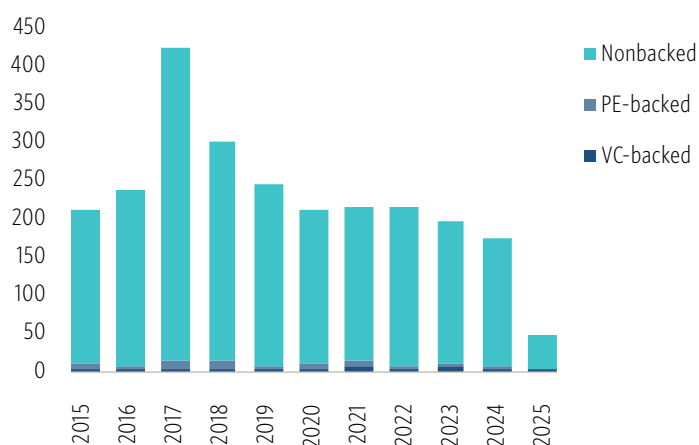
Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

Southeast Asia IPO value (\$B) by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

Southeast Asia IPO count by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

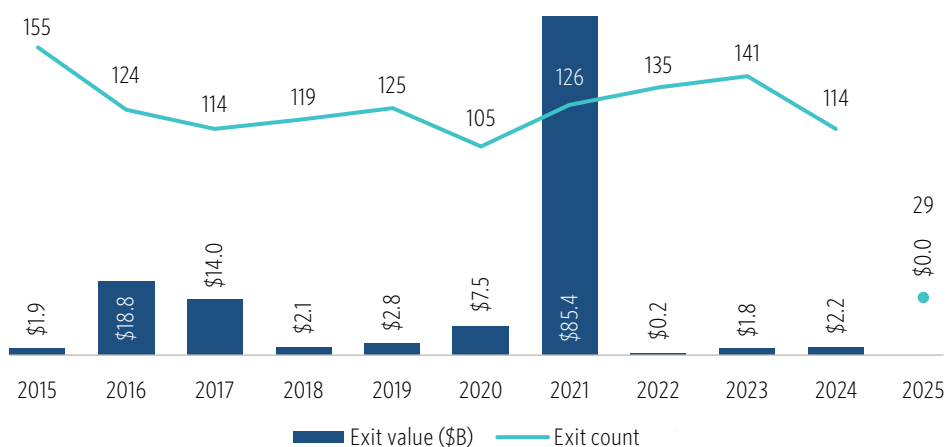
South Korea: A steady IPO engine, but bottlenecks remain

South Korea remains one of the most consistent sources of sponsor-backed IPOs in APAC, trailing only China in volume. However, the quality and scalability of outcomes are increasingly in question. In recent years, South Korea's IPO markets, particularly in the biotech and tech sectors, have drawn criticism for poor postlisting performance. Of the 13 biotech firms that listed under Korea's special tech board since 2021, only two have turned profitable, with several significantly missing financial forecasts.¹ This pattern has raised concerns about pricing discipline and earnings transparency, prompting the Financial Services Commission to announce a suite of reforms in early 2025 aimed at tightening listing standards and boosting market credibility. Key changes include stricter accounting standards, more conservative listing reviews, and expanded lockup commitments for institutional investors.

¹: "NeolmmuneTech Leads Korea's Biotech Bloodbath as IPO Firms Shed Billions on Failed Promises," Korea Biomedical Review, Kim Ji-hye, February 27, 2025.

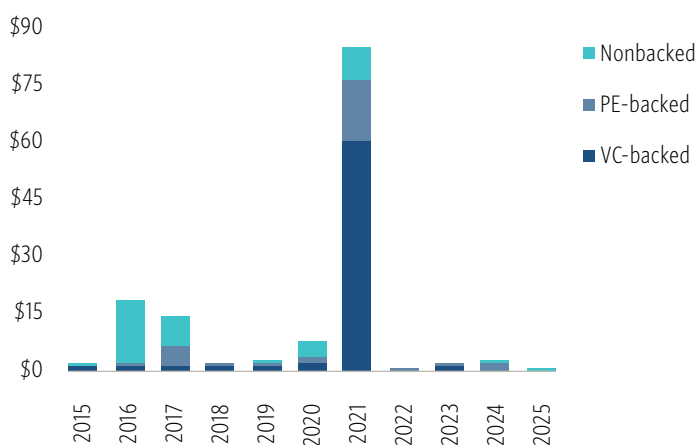
Another key weakness in Korea's IPO environment is the growing imbalance between retail and institutional conviction. While retail oversubscription has fueled several headline-grabbing debuts, such as SK IE Technology's 288x retail bid in 2021, this enthusiasm often proves short-lived. Postlisting volatility remains high, making exits vulnerable to sentiment-driven sell-offs. At the same time, institutional investors have become more cautious, particularly with preprofit companies that lack visibility on governance and financial discipline. In 2024, institutions recorded net selling on the first day for the majority of IPOs—a trend that underscores their reluctance to hold positions postoffering.²

South Korea IPO activity



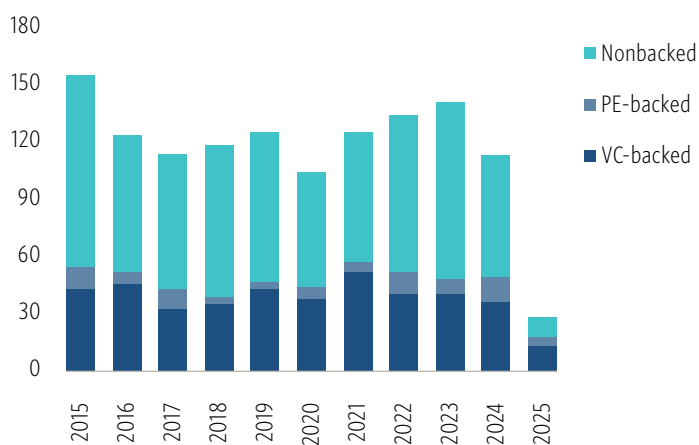
Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

South Korea IPO value (\$B) by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

South Korea IPO count by exit scope



Source: PitchBook • As of May 24, 2025

2: "South Korea Tightens Delisting and IPO Rules To Strengthen Market Credibility," The Chosun Daily, Han Ye-na, Kim Seung-hyeon, and Lee Jung-soo, January 22, 2025.

Still, Korea remains one of the few markets in APAC where IPOs are regularly executed by private-capital-backed companies, including in sectors like medtech, fintech, and semiconductors. This is because the domestic ecosystem benefits from a maturing VC landscape with consistent local follow-on funding and government incentives for tech listing pipelines.

Looking ahead, the IPO channel in Korea is likely to remain viable but increasingly selective. Companies with strong domestic product-market fit, a clear path to profitability, and well-known local backers are best positioned to succeed. However, for large, late-stage companies seeking global pricing benchmarks, Korea's capital markets may feel limiting, making dual listings or eventual M&A a more attractive long-term route.

Summary of trends

Country/region	Trends in VC/PE-backed IPOs	Typical IPO profile	Key challenges
India	Significant growth in VC/PE-backed IPOs	Scaled tech/consumer firms	Sustaining quality pipeline amid rising valuations
Japan	Steady growth; above pre-2021 average	Profitable B2B/industrial tech	Conservative investor base limits high-growth listings
China	Highly constrained; decline in VC/PE-backed IPOs	Policy-aligned or neutral consumer sectors	Regulatory hurdles, valuation caps, poor foreign access
Southeast Asia	Limited and inconsistent; decline since 2021	Medtech, semiconductors, fintech	Lack of scale
South Korea	Consistent volumes but quality concerns	Profitable mid-cap locals	Weak post-IPO performance, institutional disengagement

Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

What is next for APAC's IPO market?

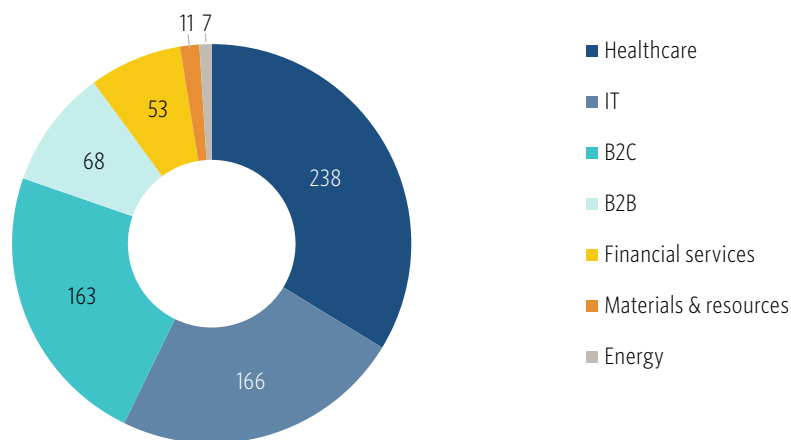
In this fragmented landscape, the question is not just which markets are open but which companies in which sectors and under what conditions are likely to exit. To help answer this, we turn to PitchBook's IPO prediction model,³ a forward-looking tool designed to identify private companies with the highest likelihood of going public over the next six to 12 months.

The forecast IPO backlog shows a clear geographic stratification. By country, South Korea ranks first, reflecting its active domestic listing culture and continued flow of VC- and PE-backed mid-cap companies to the KOSDAQ and main board. While concerns around post-IPO performance persist, particularly in biotech and tech, Korea remains one of the few APAC markets where sponsor-backed IPOs are both frequent and institutionally accepted.

³: This forecast excludes China.

India follows, driven by a robust pipeline of consumer-facing and fintech-oriented businesses that have benefited from strong domestic demand and public market appetite for earnings visibility. Japan lags slightly, as its listing environment favors smaller, domestic firms with predictable cash flows—of which fewer are institutionally backed. Southeast Asia stands at the bottom of the pack. In Southeast Asia, as noted earlier, structural challenges around scale, liquidity, and governance readiness limit the pipeline of viable public market exits.

Successful VC IPO prediction count by sector



Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

The most IPO-ready companies fall within three key sectors: B2C, healthcare, and IT. IPO readiness is driven by the sector's long-term demographic tailwinds, government prioritization, and growing commercial viability across subsegments such as biopharma, medtech, and diagnostics, particularly in South Korea. Demand for B2C is driven by large, consumption-driven populations, which create fertile ground for digital platforms and retail brands. Meanwhile, IT stands out for its IPO potential across APAC, regardless of the country. Our IPO prediction model shows an equal number of high-probability IT candidates in India, Japan, and South Korea, highlighting how digital infrastructure, enterprise software, and applied AI are maturing simultaneously across multiple ecosystems. Rather than waiting for a broad reopening, investors and founders will need to actively target exits where structural support, investor appetite, and market access already align. In this new cycle, navigating the IPO path will be less about timing the window and more about matching the fundamentals to the right market.

Top 22 high-probability IPO candidates in core APAC markets (India, Japan, Korea, Southeast Asia)

97% BLUESTONE Location: India Sector: B2C	96% OLA Location: India Sector: B2C	96% OYO Location: India Sector: B2C	95% CUREFOODS Location: India Sector: B2C	95% Hummingbird Bioscience Location: Singapore Sector: Healthcare
95% purple Location: India Sector: B2C	95% rapido Location: India Sector: B2C	95% upGrad Location: India Sector: IT	94% carousell Location: Singapore Sector: B2C	94% meesho Location: India Sector: B2C
94% SHOPBACK Location: Singapore Sector: B2C	94% toss Location: South Korea Sector: IT	93% funding societies Location: Singapore Sector: Financial services	93% girnarSOFT Location: India Sector: IT	93% PeptiStar Location: Japan Sector: Healthcare
93% Perfios Lead Leap Location: India Sector: IT	93% Riiid Location: South Korea Sector: IT	93% sk FINANCE Location: India Sector: Financial services	92% L-BASE Location: South Korea Sector: Healthcare	92% LALAMOVE Location: Hong Kong Sector: B2B
92% MICRO CONNECT Location: Hong Kong Sector: Financial services		92% SHEIN Location: Singapore Sector: B2C		

Source: PitchBook • Geography: APAC • As of May 24, 2025

Note: Percentages refer to the likelihood of an IPO according to the PitchBook [VC Exit Predictor methodology](#).